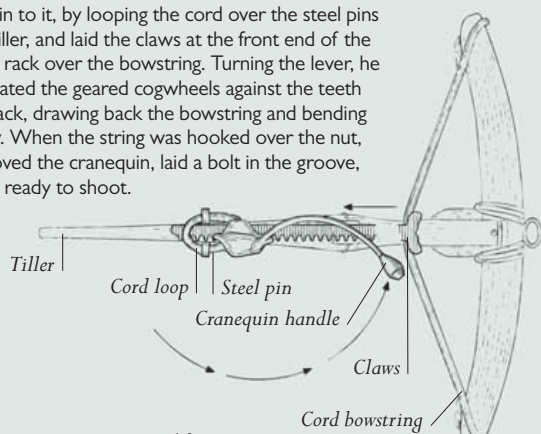


IN ACTION

LOADING THE CROSSBOW

To prepare the crossbow, the archer first anchored the cranequin to it, by looping the cord over the steel pins on the tiller, and laid the claws at the front end of the toothed rack over the bowstring. Turning the lever, he then rotated the geared cogwheels against the teeth of the rack, drawing back the bowstring and bending the bow. When the string was hooked over the nut, he removed the cranequin, laid a bolt in the groove, and was ready to shoot.



► The cranequin was essential for pulling the powerful draw-weight.

Composite bow, made of horn, sinew, and wood

Cord bridle binds tiller to bow

Triangular metal head

Cord bowstring

Toothed rack

Curved claws grip bowstring

Cranequin handle